

Here is a different case which, many think, the Probability Splitting Rule says just the right thing about.

The poll

I put an argument on the screen, and conduct a poll, asking you to say whether the argument is valid or invalid. You confidently answer “Valid.” When the poll results show up, you find to your surprise that you are the only student who answered this way.

What should you say in this case? Why?

Why? We can think of this as a case in which you have many simultaneous disagreements. Supposing for simplicity that everyone initially has credence 1 in her answer, the Probability Splitting Rule would suggest that you should lower your credence in your initial answer to 0.5, then to 0.25, then to 0.125, then to a small number.

Let's suppose for the moment that Probability-Splitting gives the correct response to cases of peer disagreement. Does this have any practical consequences?

Consider any religious, moral, or political view you have. There would seem to be plenty of people who have the same evidence as you, have thought about the issues as much as you, and are as smart as you, who have a view opposite to yours.

This suggests an argument with massive consequences for what you believe about these domains.

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P's created the average of N and M.

The probability splitting rule

If you assign P to N , and N to

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